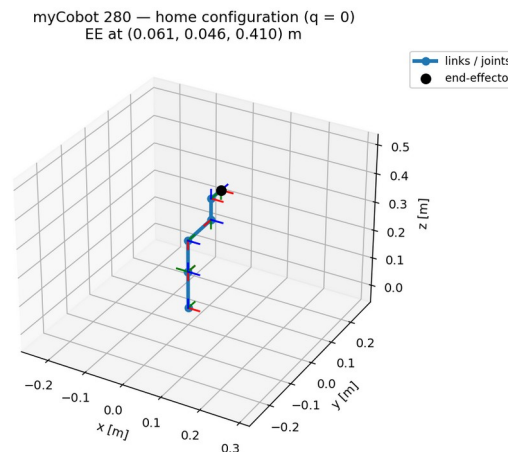


R_sine — Drawing a Sine Wave with a myCobot 280

Analytical kinematics + inverse kinematics on a 6-DOF arm (ROS 2)



Objective and Method

- Forward kinematics: where is the tool, given the joint angles?
- Jacobian: how tool velocity relates to joint velocities
- Inverse kinematics: which joint angles reach a desired tool pose?
- Pipeline: sine path -> IK per point -> joint trajectory -> RViz

Modified (Craig) DH Convention

Four parameters relate each pair of link frames

- α_{i-1} : link twist — angle between successive joint axes
- a_{i-1} : link length — offset between successive joint axes
- d_i : link offset along the joint axis
- θ_i : joint angle (the variable for a revolute joint)
- Link transform: $\text{Rotx}(\alpha) \cdot \text{Transx}(a) \cdot \text{Rotz}(\theta) \cdot \text{Transz}(d)$

Identified DH Table (verified to 1e-15 m)

Fitted from the URDF, then checked against it

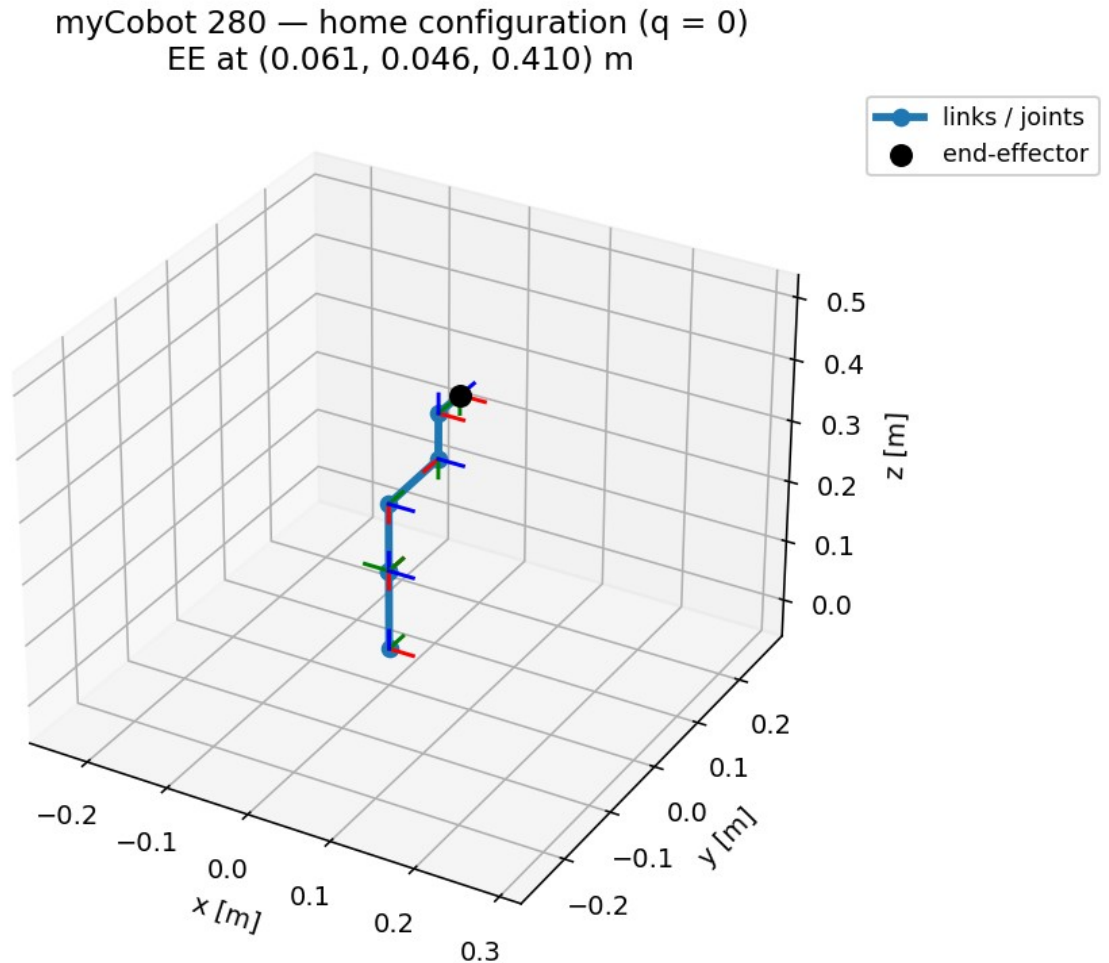
- URDF link frames are not on DH axes -> table was identified numerically
- Fit (alpha, a, d, theta-offset) so DH-FK reproduces URDF-FK
- Residual is machine-zero: $\max | \text{DH-FK} - \text{URDF-FK} | \sim 1\text{e-15 m}$
- Physically clean 'concentrated' convention chosen for readability

i	alpha (deg)	a (m)	d (m)	theta off (deg)
1	0	0	0.13056	+90
2	+90	0	0	-90
3	0	-0.1104	0	0
4	0	-0.096	0.06062	-90
5	+90	0	0.07318	+90
6	-90	0	0.0456	0

Forward Kinematics

Product of the six link transforms

- $T_{EE} = T_1 \cdot T_2 \cdot T_3 \cdot T_4 \cdot T_5 \cdot T_6$
- Home pose (all joints 0): tool at (0.061, 0.046, 0.410) m
- Independently confirmed by ikpy's FK ($\sim 1e-16$ m)



Jacobian — Velocity Propagation

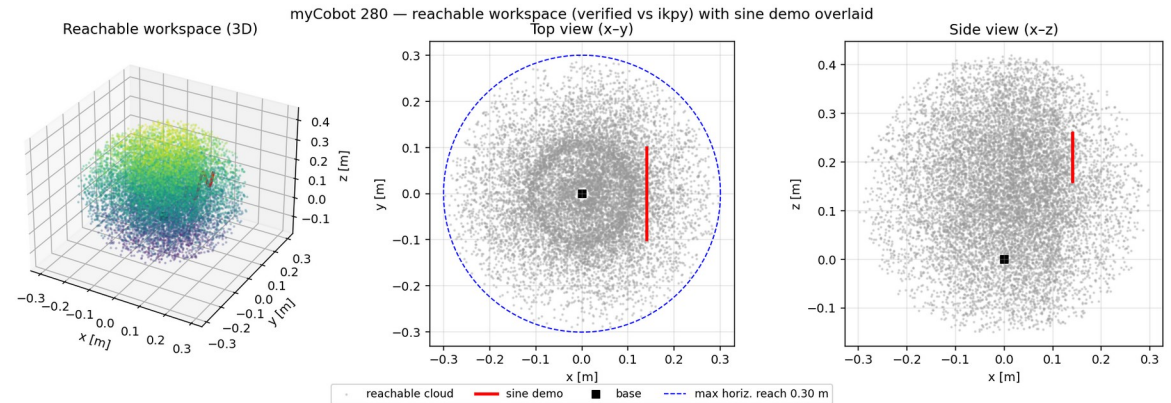
Built frame-by-frame, verified against finite differences

- Propagate angular & linear velocity outward: base $\rightarrow$ tool
- For revolute joints reduces to columns $[z_i \times (p_e - p_i) ; z_i]$
- Maps joint rates to tool twist: $[v; \omega] = J(q) \dot{q}$
- Verified vs numerical Jacobian to $\sim 2.5e-7$

Reachable Workspace (verified)

Where the tool can go — the sine sits well inside it

- Sampled by FK over 40,000 valid joint configurations
- Max 3D reach 0.427 m; max horizontal reach 0.301 m
- Cross-checked against ikpy FK to $\sim 1.7\text{e-}16$ m
- The demo sine lies safely inside the reachable set



Inverse Kinematics — Damped Least Squares

Jacobian-based, robust near singularities

- $q_{k+1} = q_k + J^T (J J^T + \lambda^2 I)^{-1} e$
- $e = [\text{position error} ; \text{orientation error}]$ (6-vector)
- Damping λ keeps updates stable near singularities
- ~16 iterations per waypoint; solutions clamped to joint limits

Configurable Drawing Plane

Same code, any surface

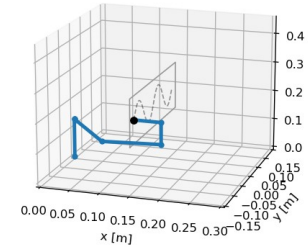
- Plane defined by origin + two in-plane axes (advance u, wave v)
- Pen kept perpendicular to the surface (flange z along the normal)
- Solver auto-picks the reachable pen direction (+/- normal)
- Vertical board or flat plate — only the parameters change

Result — Drawing the Sine

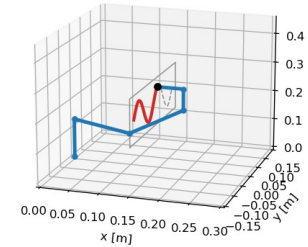
Tool traces the target to sub-millimetre accuracy

- 20 cm wide, 10 cm tall, 2-cycle sine on a vertical board
- Pen held perpendicular to the board throughout
- Drawn path overlays the target essentially perfectly

myCobot 280 drawing a sine (frame 1/100)

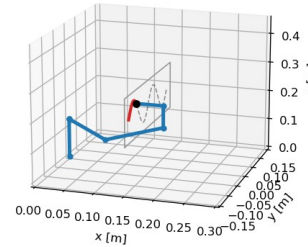


myCobot 280 drawing a sine (frame 60/100)

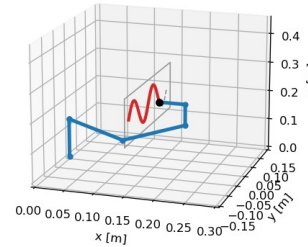


Progression of the drawn sine (left→right, top→bottom)

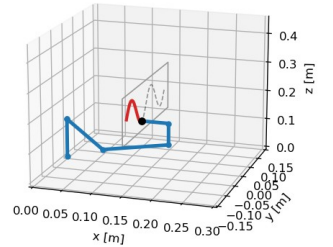
myCobot 280 drawing a sine (frame 20/100)



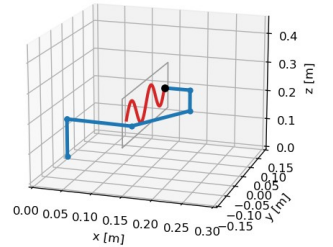
myCobot 280 drawing a sine (frame 80/100)



myCobot 280 drawing a sine (frame 40/100)



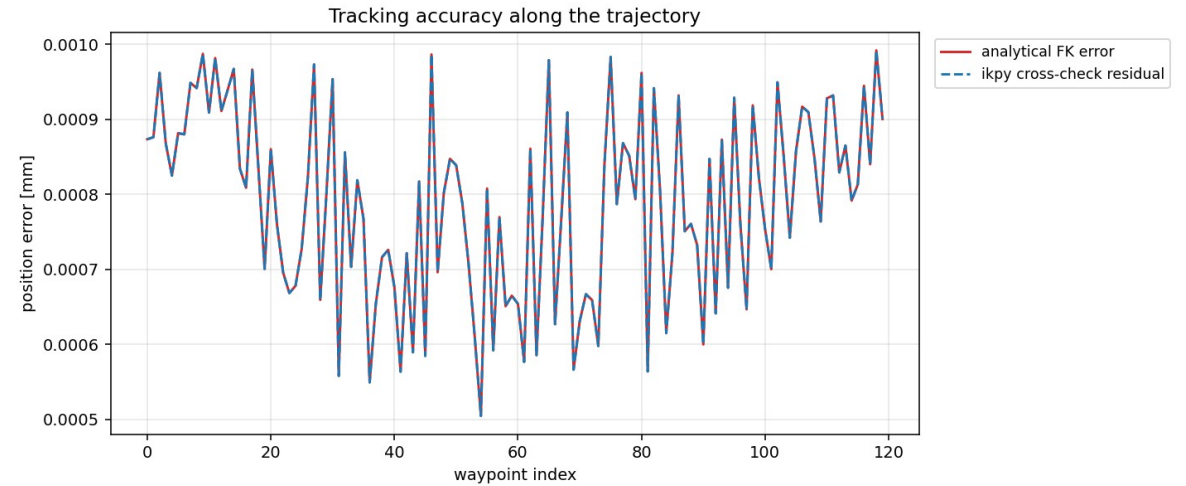
myCobot 280 drawing a sine (frame 100/100)



Accuracy and Verification

Numbers behind the result

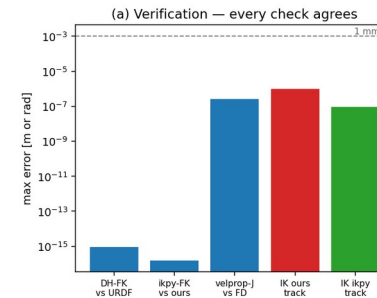
- DH-FK vs URDF-FK: $\sim 1\text{e-}15$ m
- Velocity-propagation Jacobian vs finite differences: $\sim 2.5\text{e-}7$
- Analytical IK tracking error: ~ 0.001 mm
- ikpy cross-check on every waypoint: ~ 0.001 mm



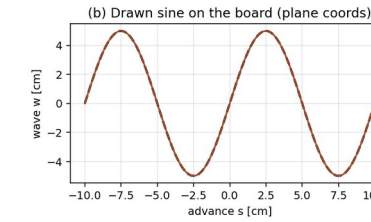
Analytical vs ikpy

Independent methods, same answer

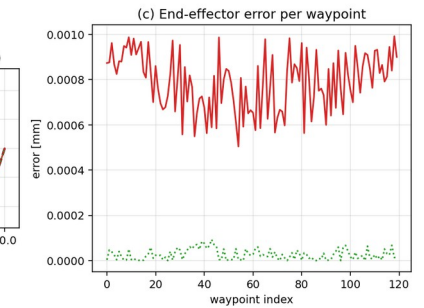
- My analytical FK/Jacobian/IK vs the ikpy library
- All agreement checks are far below 1 mm (log scale)
- Both solvers trace the same sine



Analytical (ours) vs ikpy — myCobot 280 sine tracing



— target — analytical IK — ikpy IK



ROS 2 Architecture

Clean, separate Python nodes

- kinematics.py / ik.py / sine_path.py — pure math, no ROS
- sine_ik_node — precomputes IK, streams /joint_states at 30 Hz
- path_tracer_node — accumulates the real drawn line from TF
- One launch file -> robot_state_publisher + nodes + RViz

Conclusion and Future Work

- First-principles kinematics, fully verified, drawing a sine in ROS 2
- General plane + shape: extensible beyond a sine on a board
- Next: run on the physical myCobot 280; add a real pen and contact
- Next: Gazebo physics; trajectory timing / velocity limits

myCobot 280 drawing a sine on a vertical board

